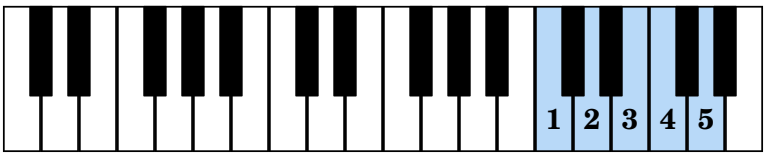
Unit 3

High Notes

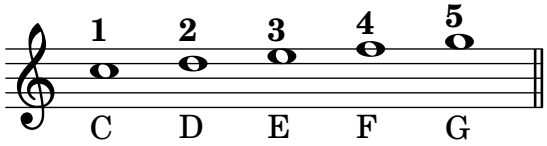
New: Ledger lines above the treble staff, up to D6; the hand moves up an octave

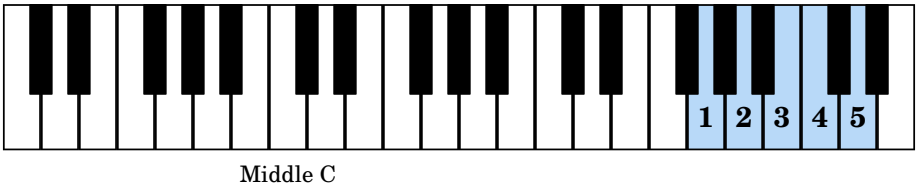
The treble staff ends at F, on its top line. Notes above it are written on short extra lines called ledger lines. Counting ledger lines note by note is slow; instead, learn a few landmarks and read from them. In this unit the right hand works in two high positions, and also jumps up and down an octave.



Right hand high C position: finger numbers on the keys

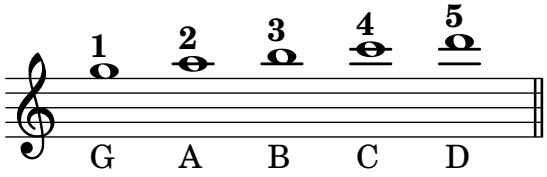
Your five notes





Right hand high G position: finger numbers on the keys

Your five notes



What is new

Ledger lines above

G5 sits just above the staff. A5 is on the first ledger line, B5 just above it, and high C (C6) on the second ledger line. D6 sits above two ledger lines.

Landmarks

Know three Cs at a glance: middle C on its own ledger line below the staff, C5 in the third space, and C6 on two ledger lines above. Read nearby notes as steps from the nearest C.

The octave move

Moving a hand up an octave changes a note on a line to the same letter in a space, and the other way round: G4 is on a line, G5 is in a space. A finger number marks the move.

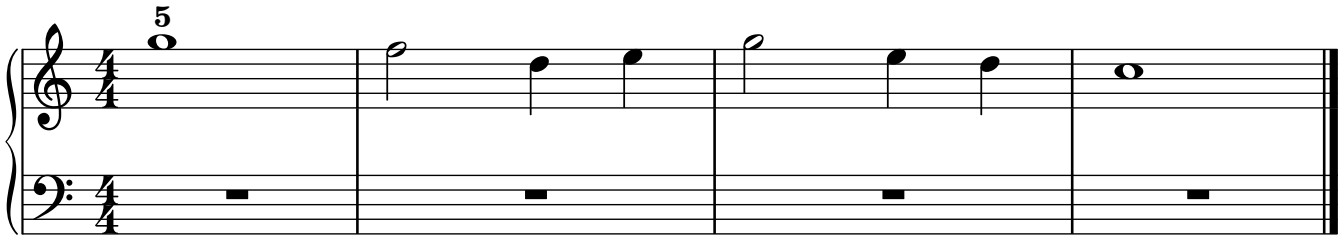
Reading tips

1. In your scan, find the highest note and name it from a landmark before you start.
2. For an octave move, keep the same finger on the same letter and let the arm carry the hand.
3. Play high notes lightly: they sound bright and carry easily.
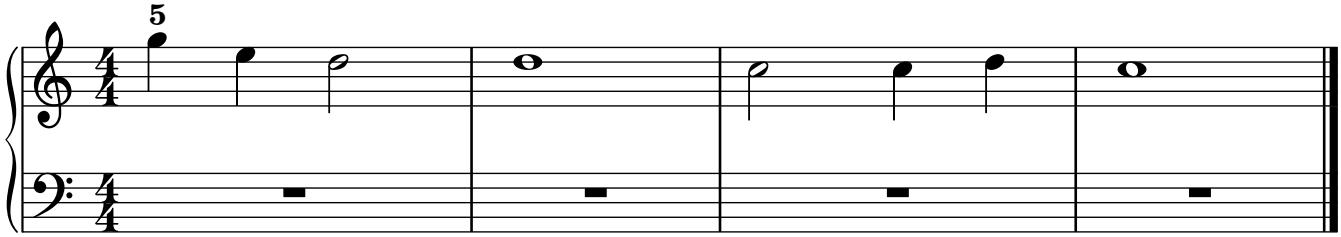
Part A: High C position ♩ = 60

Right hand in high C position: C5 (thumb) to G5 (finger 5).

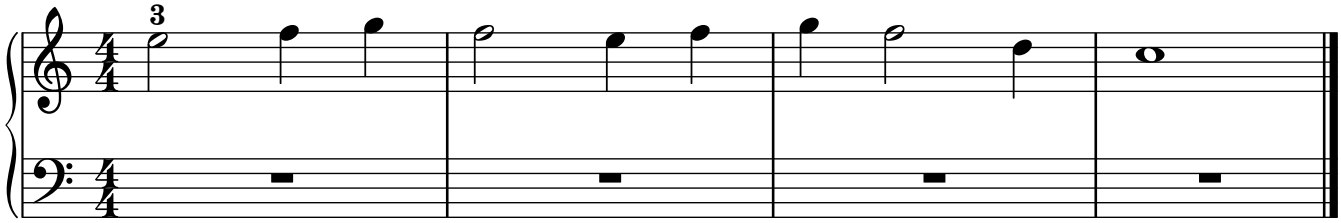
☐ **3.1**



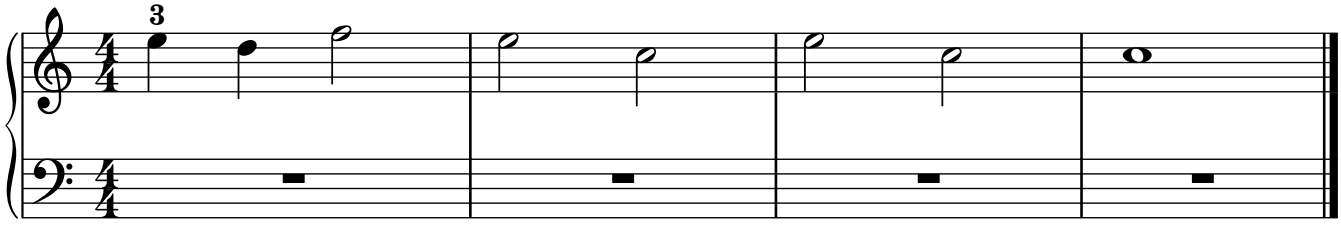
☐ **3.2**



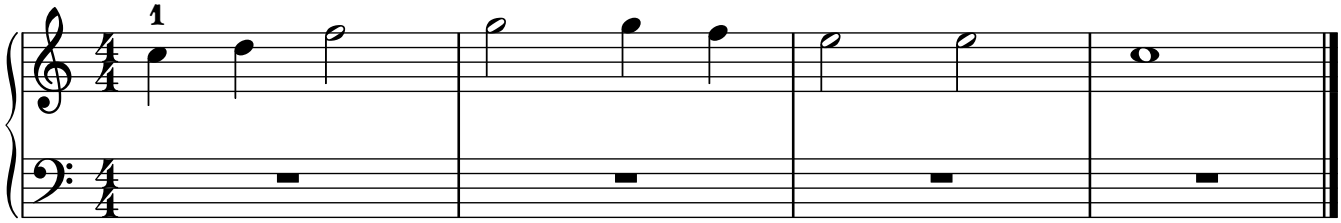
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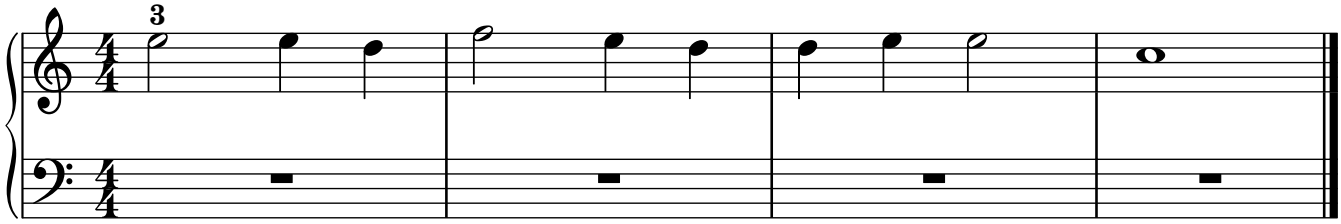
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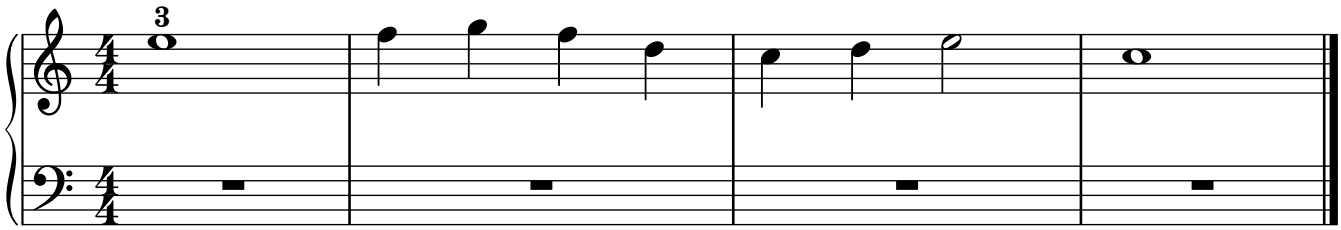
☐ **3.5**



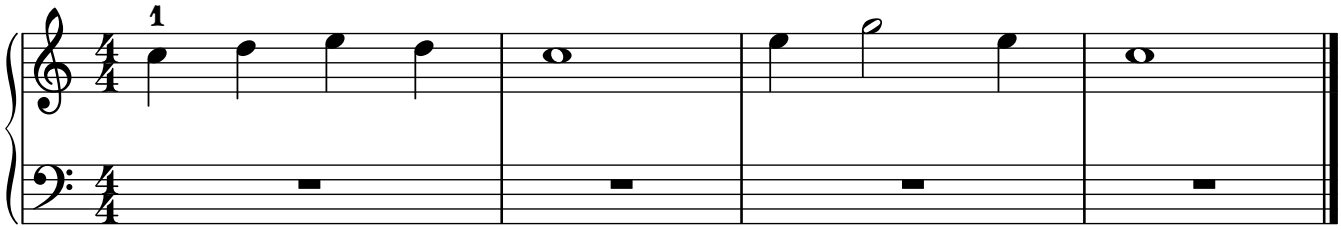
☐ **3.6**



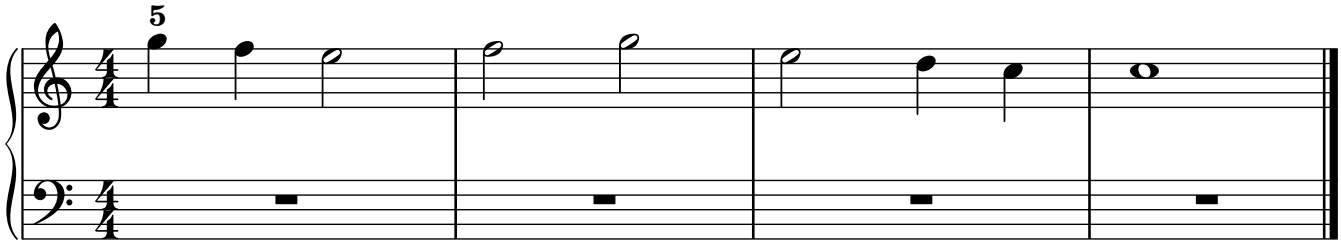
☐ **3.7**



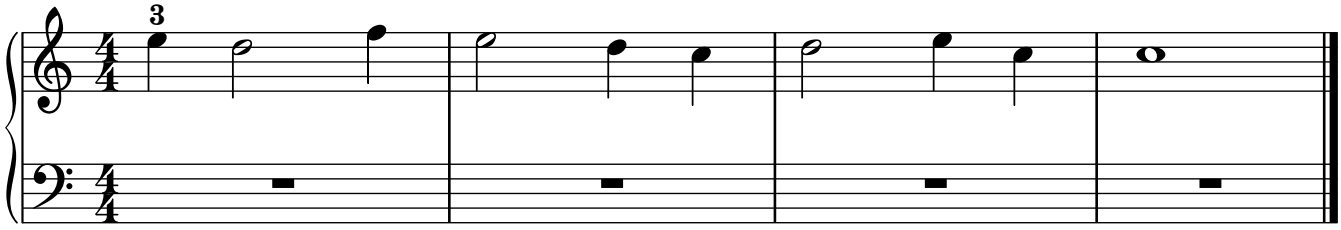
☐ **3.8**



☐ **3.9**



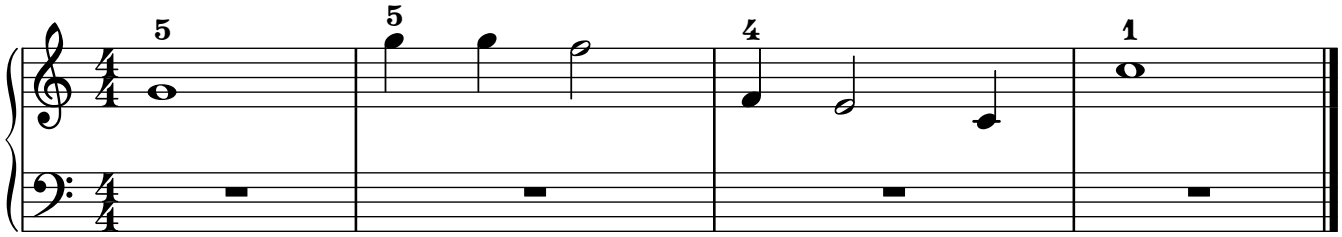
☐ **3.10**



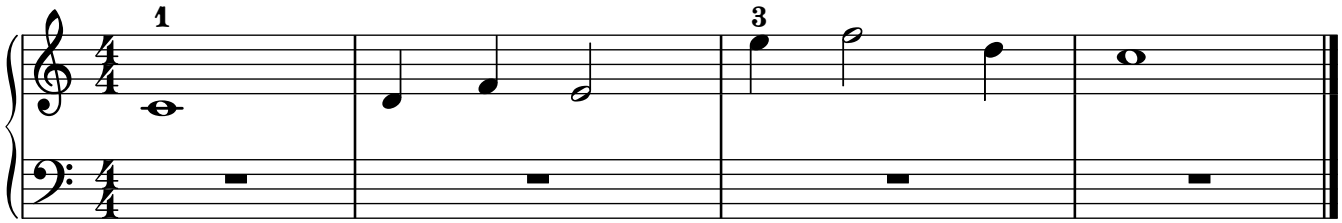
Part B: Up and down an octave ♩ = 60

The right hand moves between C position and high C position, an octave apart. Watch the finger numbers.

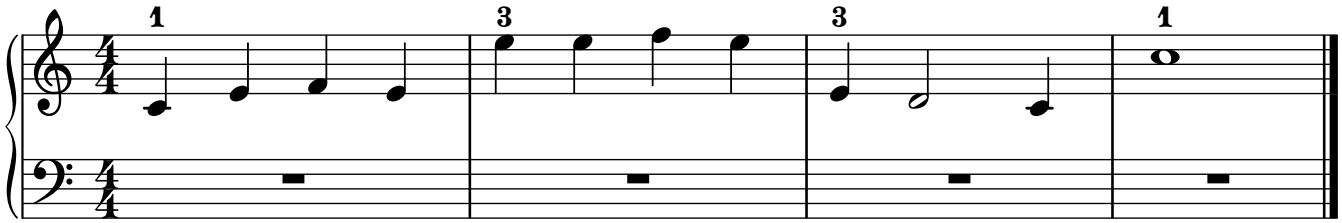
☐ **3.11**



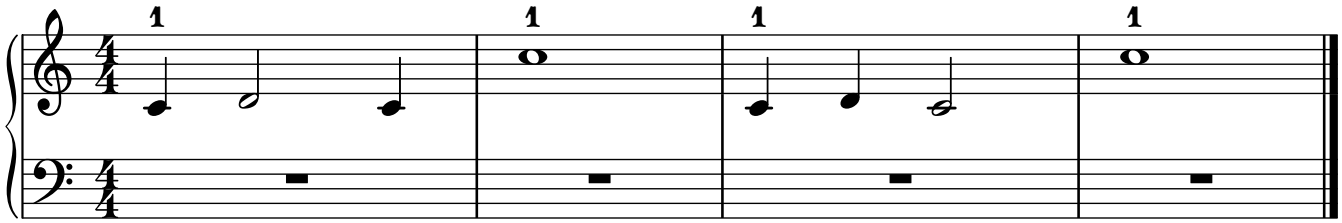
☐ **3.12**



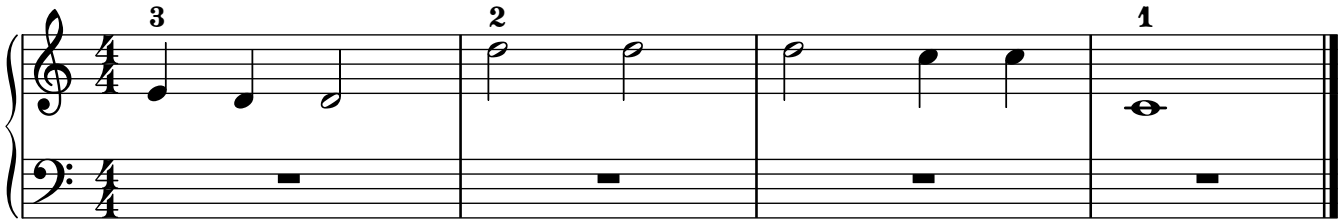
☐ **3.13**



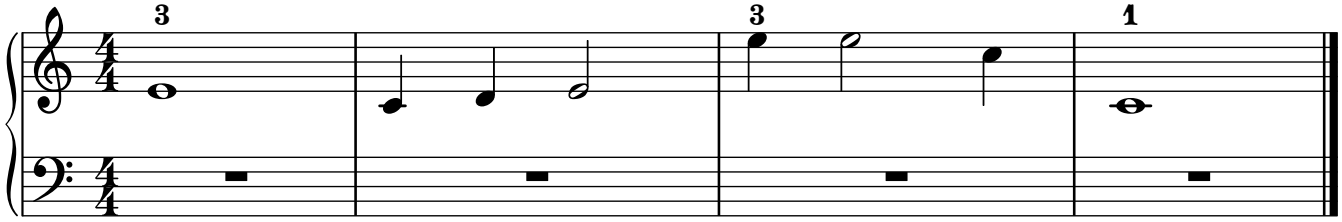
☐ **3.14**



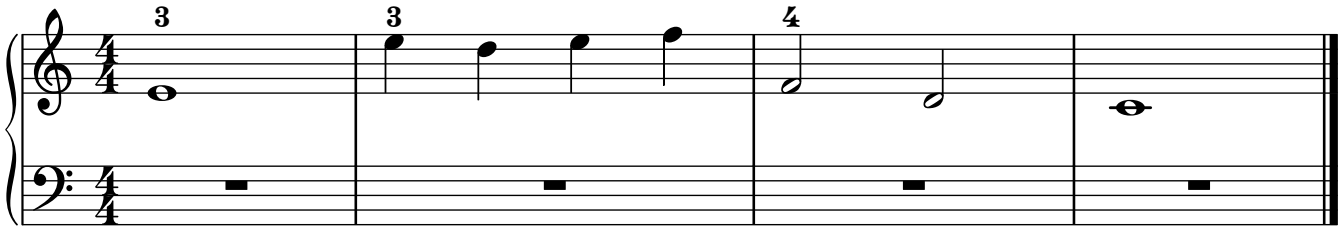
☐ **3.15**



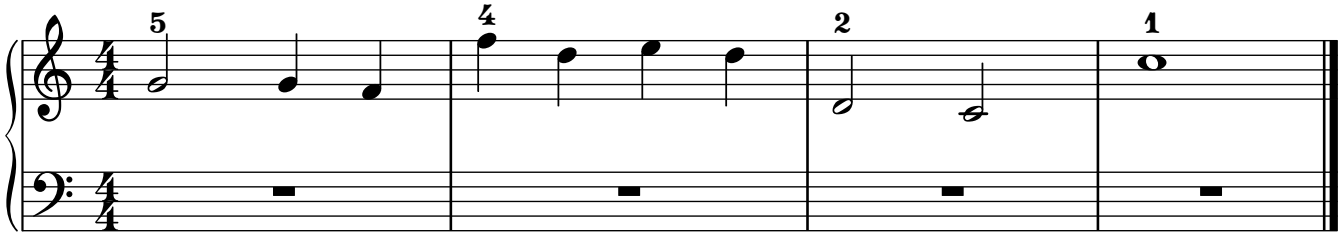
☐ **3.16**



3.17



3.18

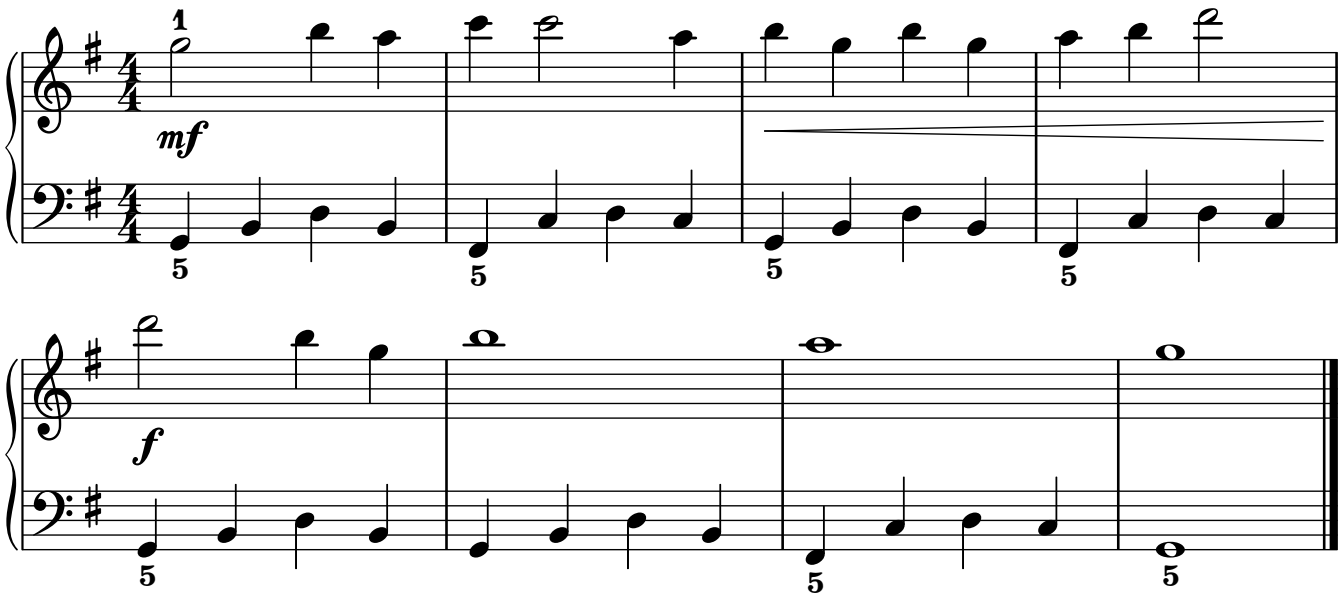


Part C: High G position over broken chords

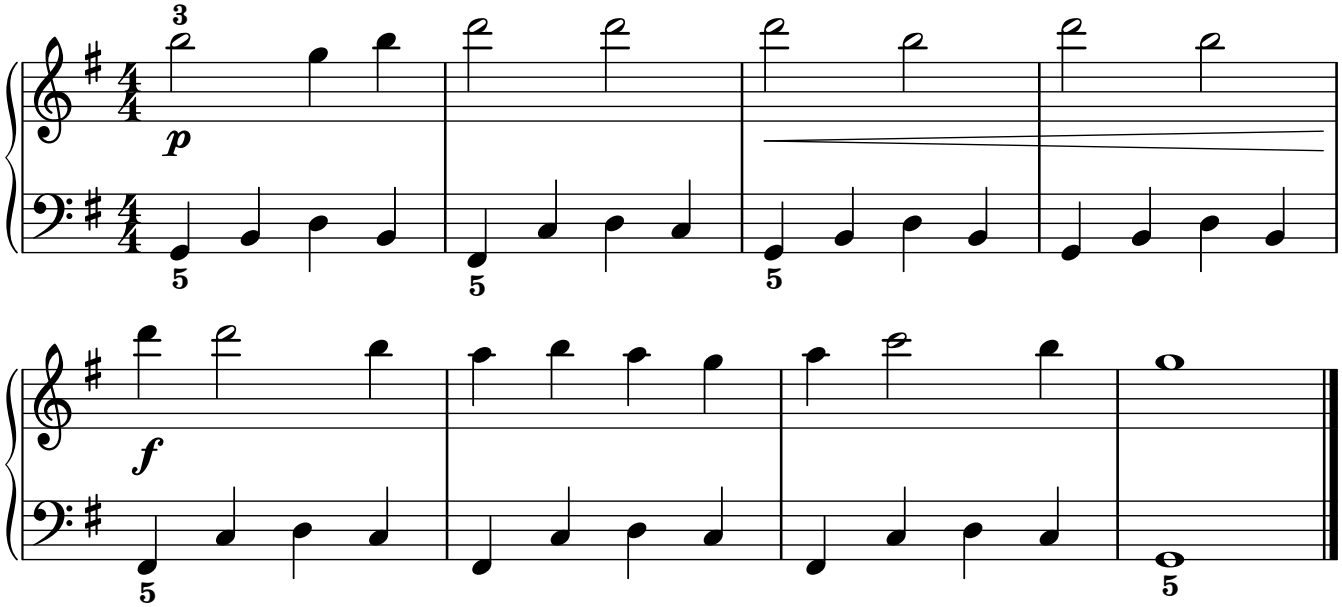
♩ = 66

G major: the right hand in high G position (G5 to D6) over broken chords.

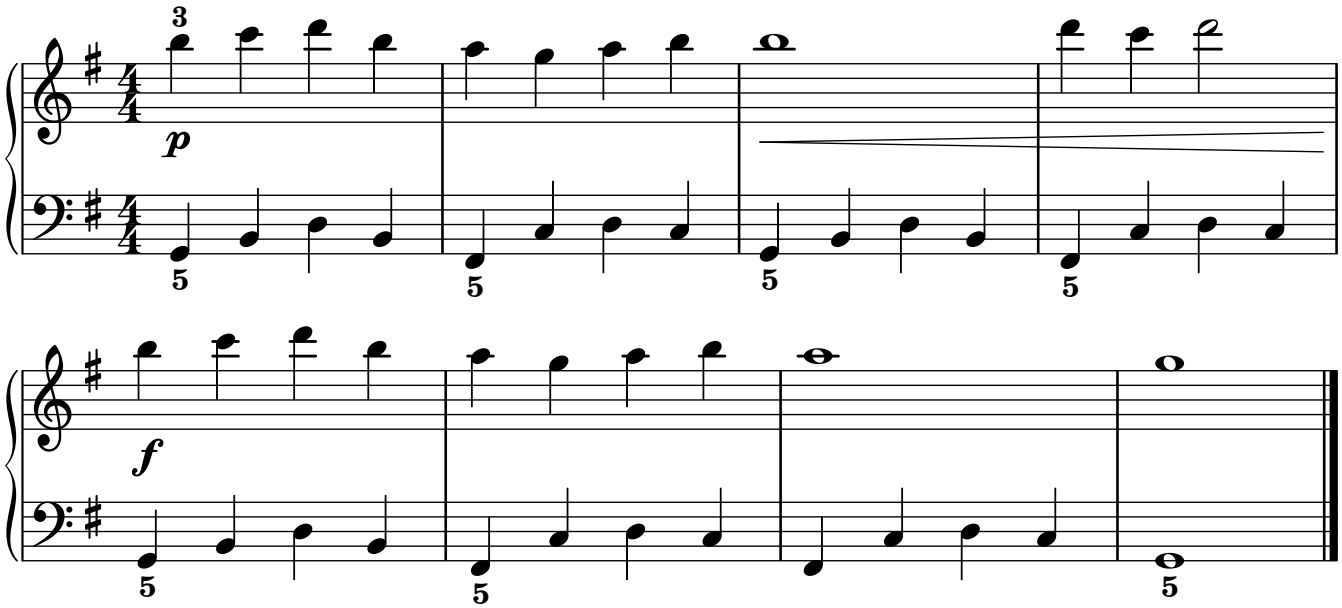
☐ **3.19**



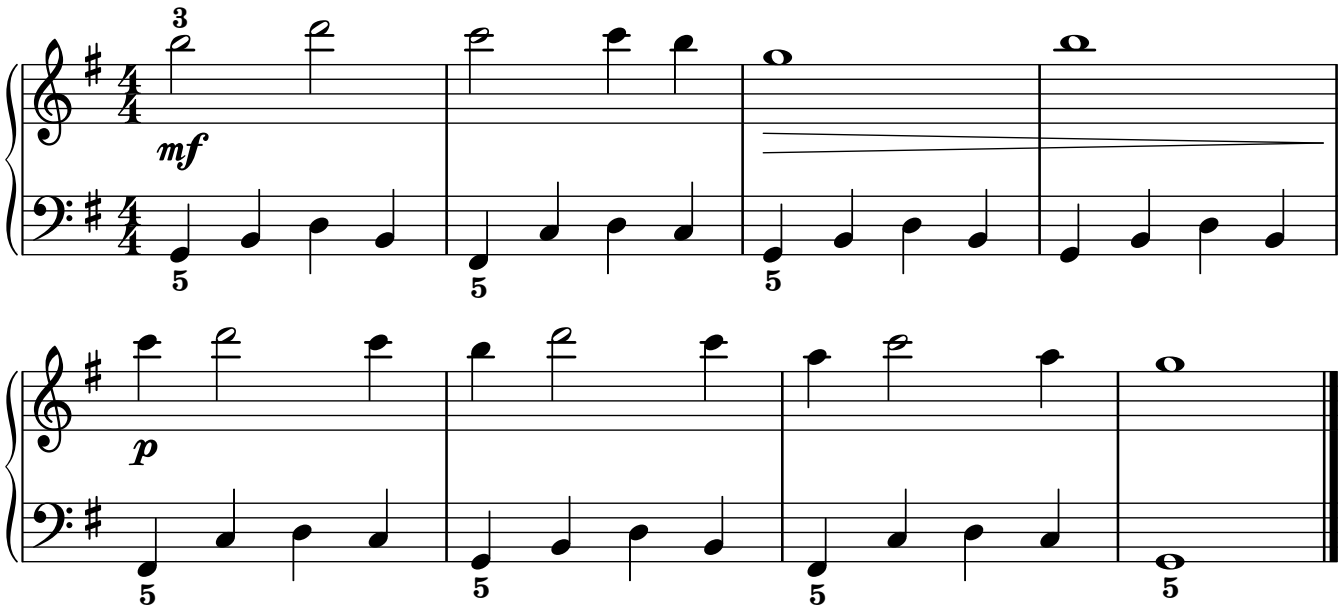
☐ **3.20**



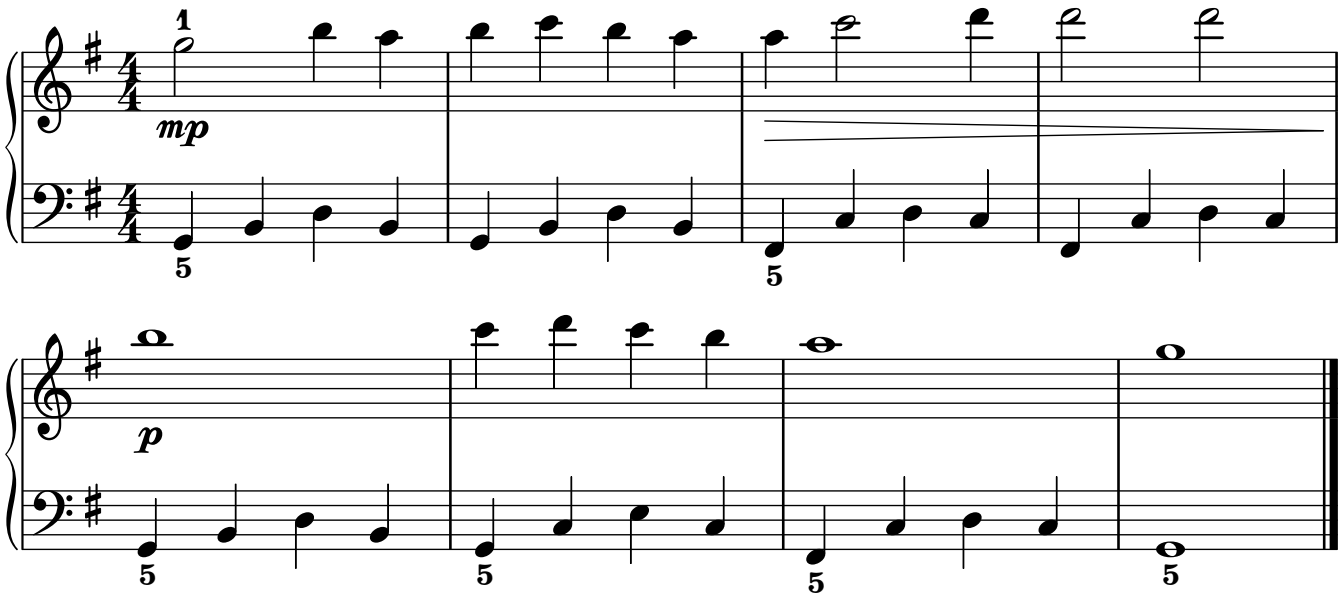
3.21



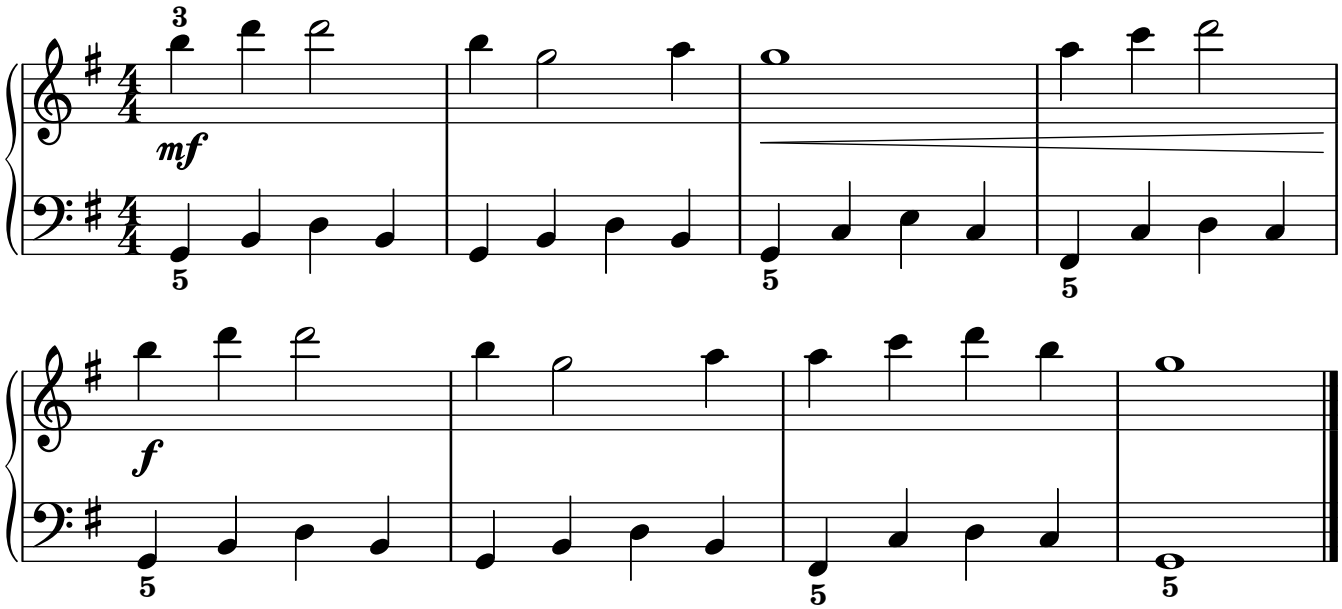
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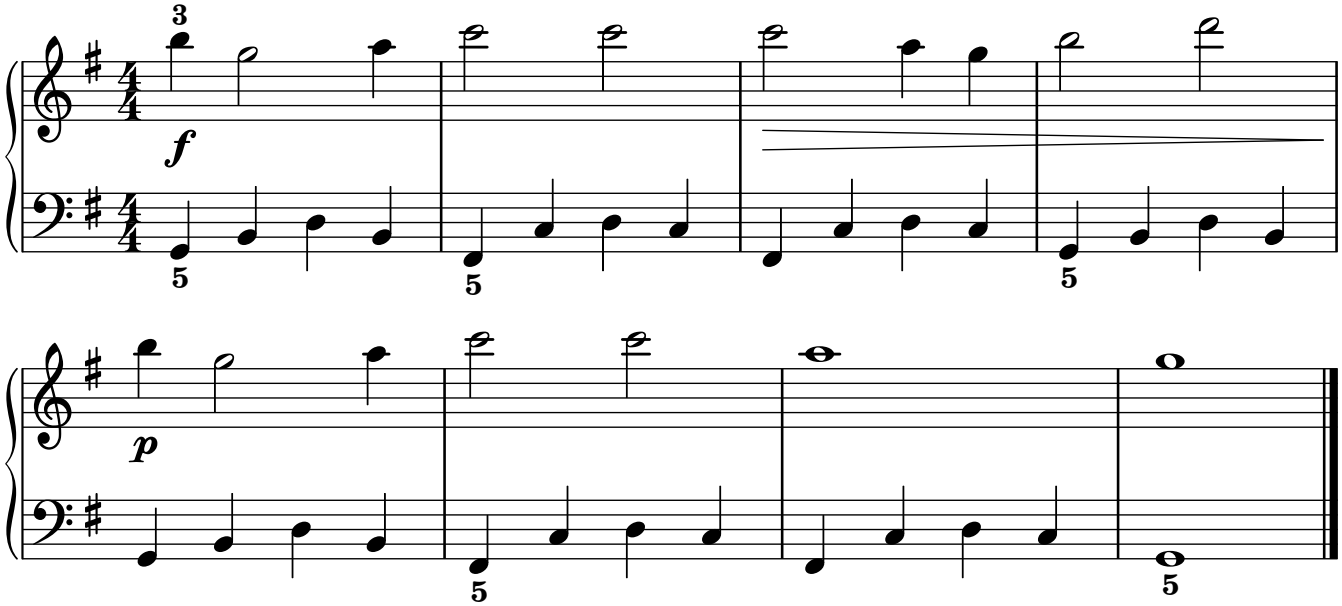
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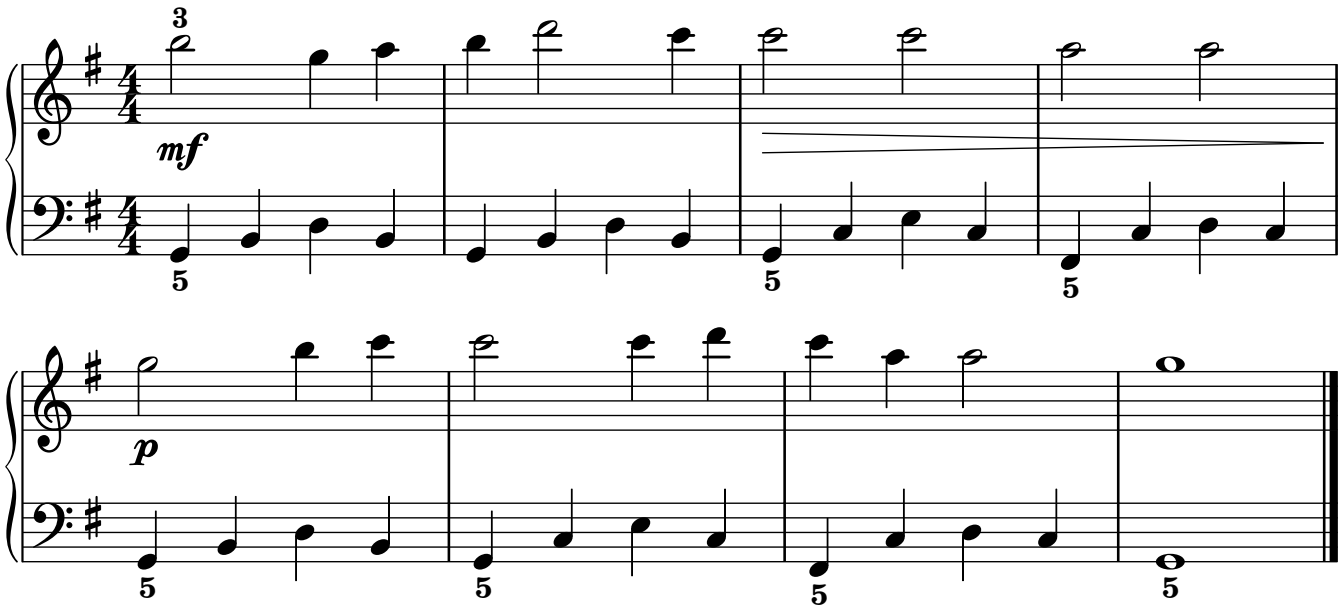
3.24



3.25



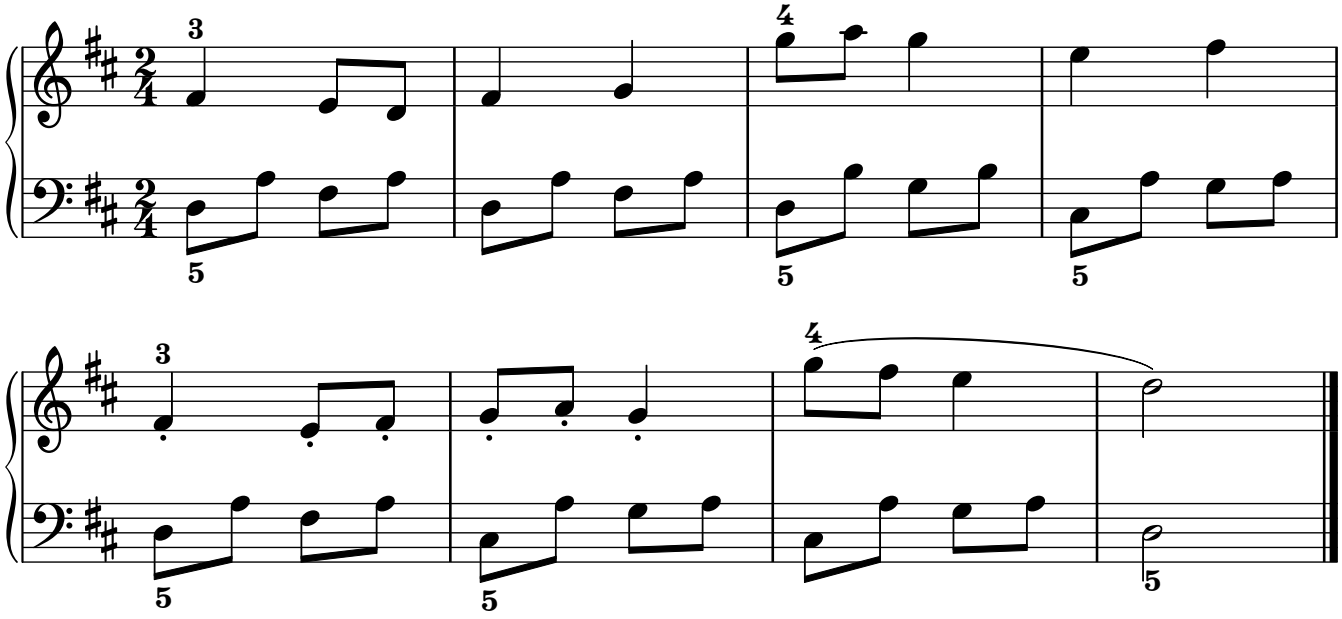
3.26



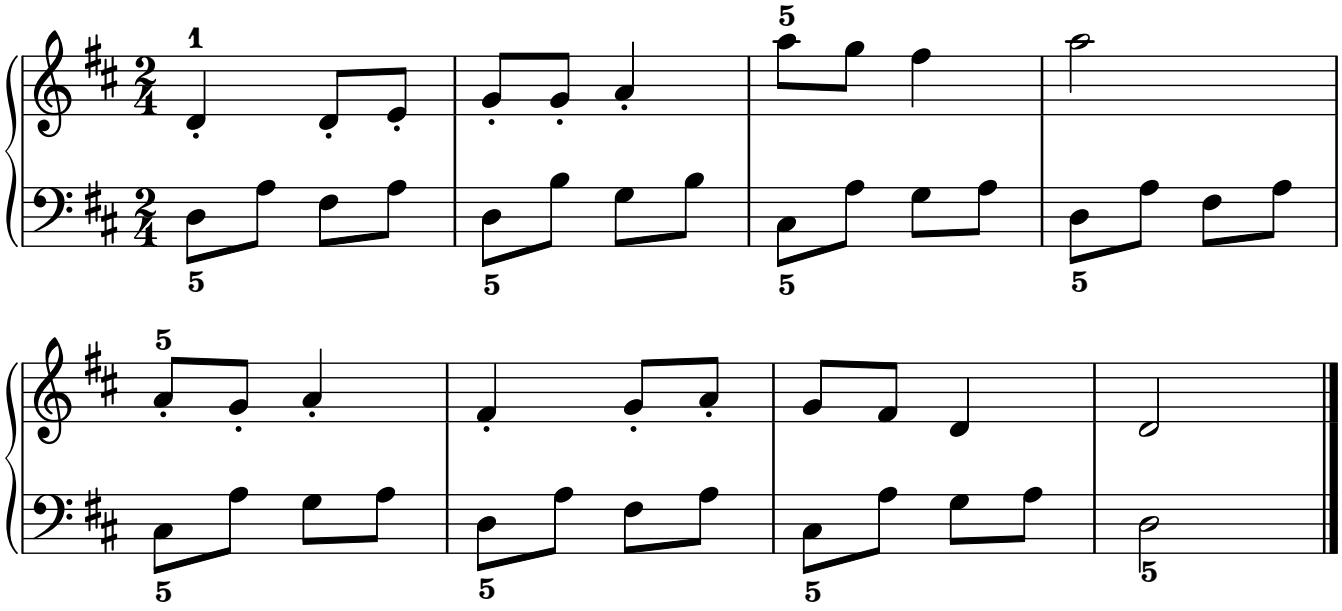
Part D: D major in 2/4, high and low ♩ = 80

D major in 2/4: the right hand moves between D position and high D position over an Alberti bass.

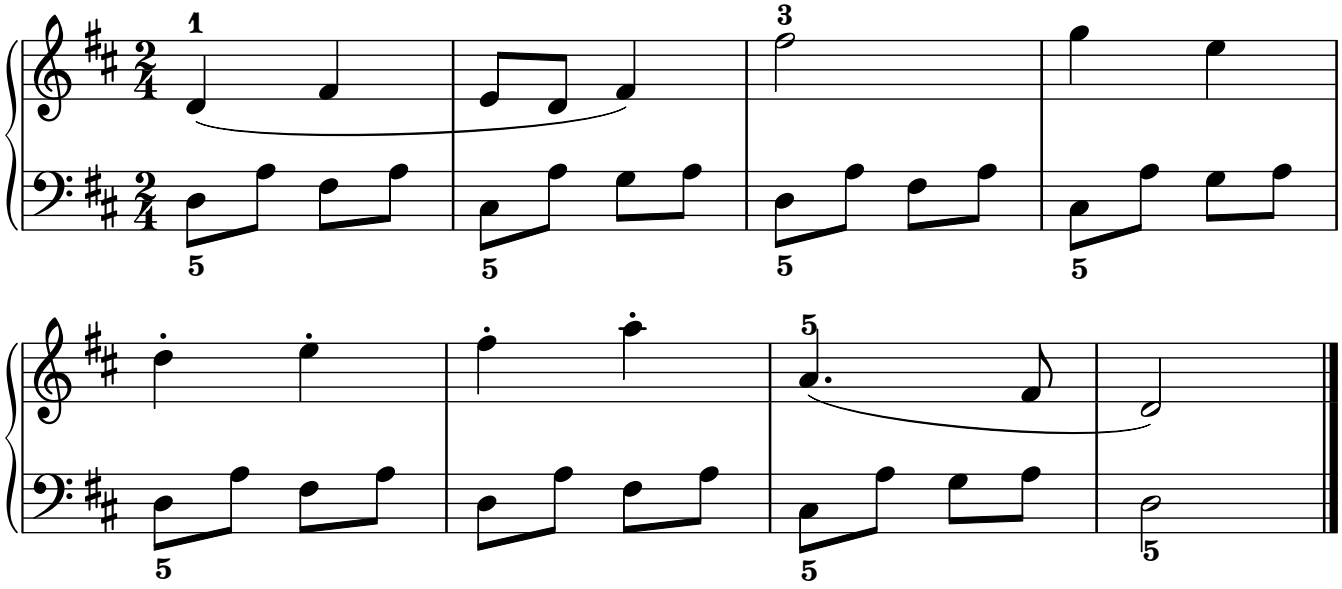
☐ **3.27**



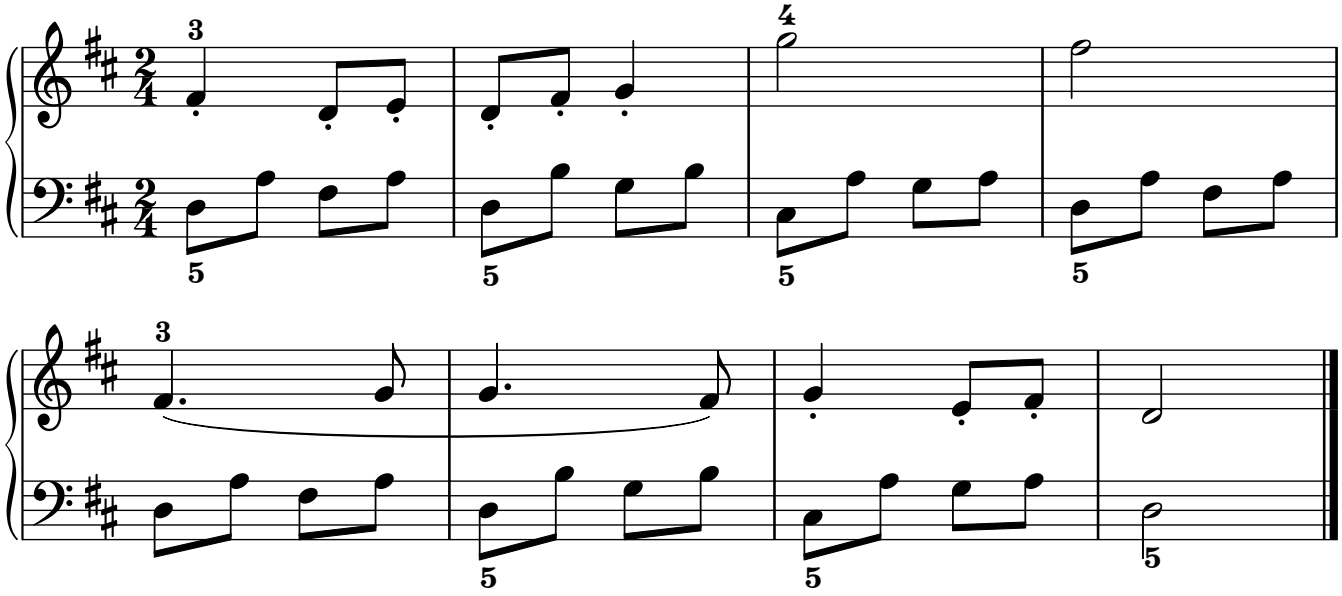
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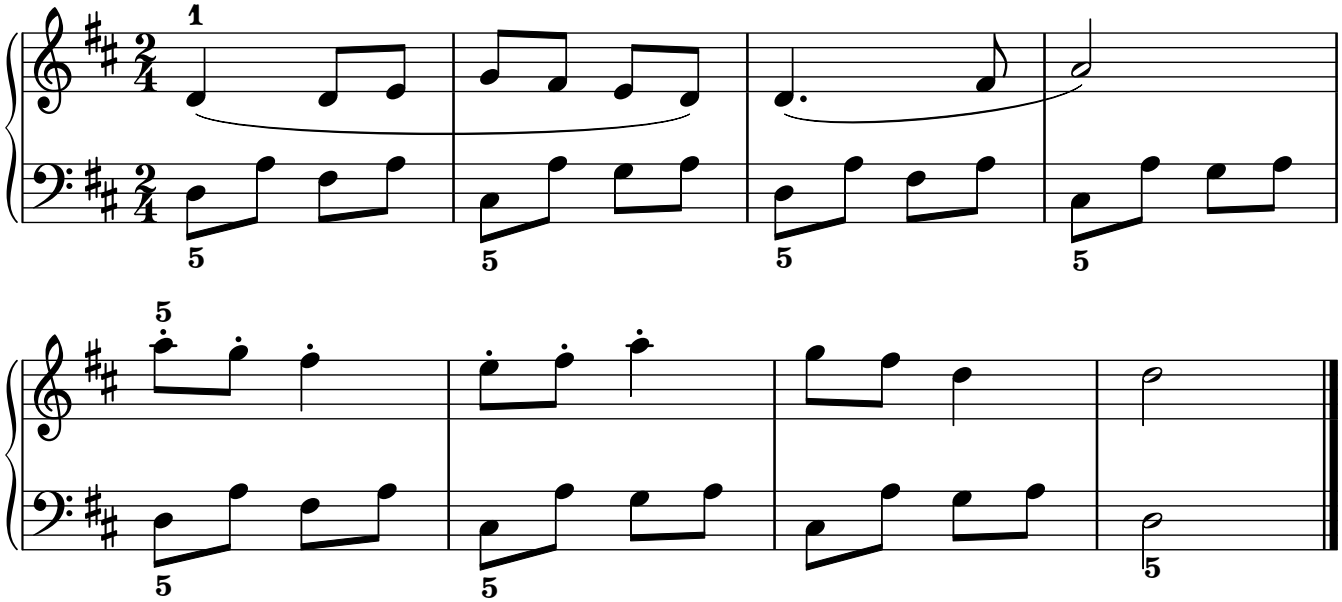


3.29



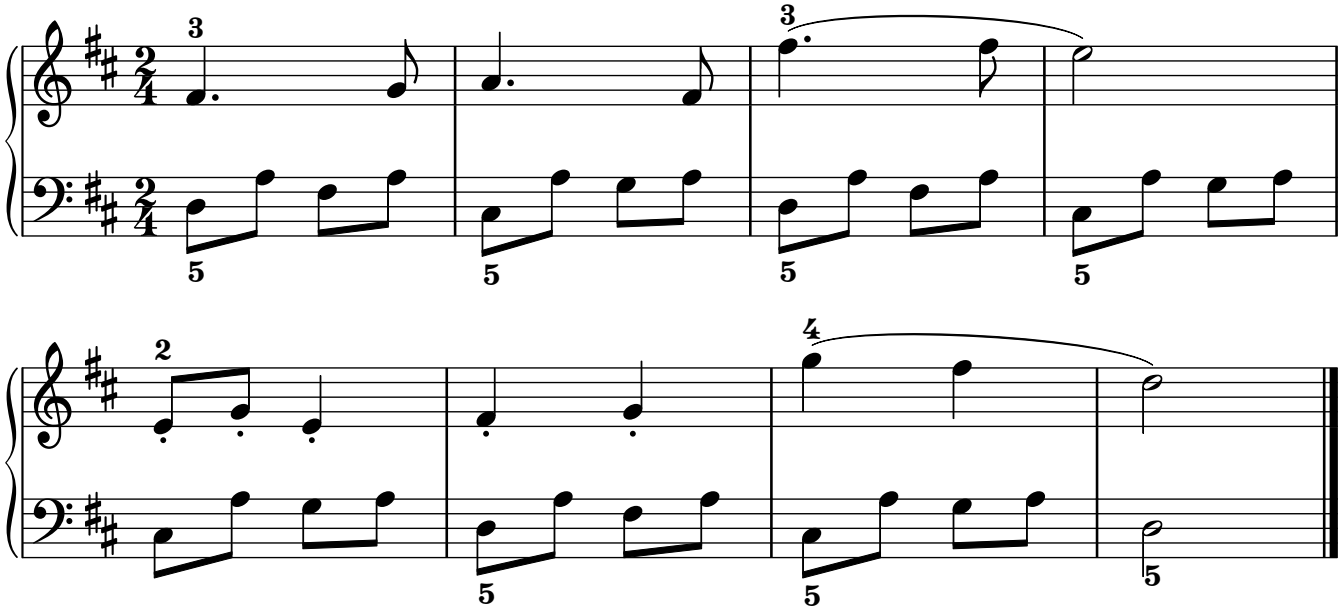
3.30



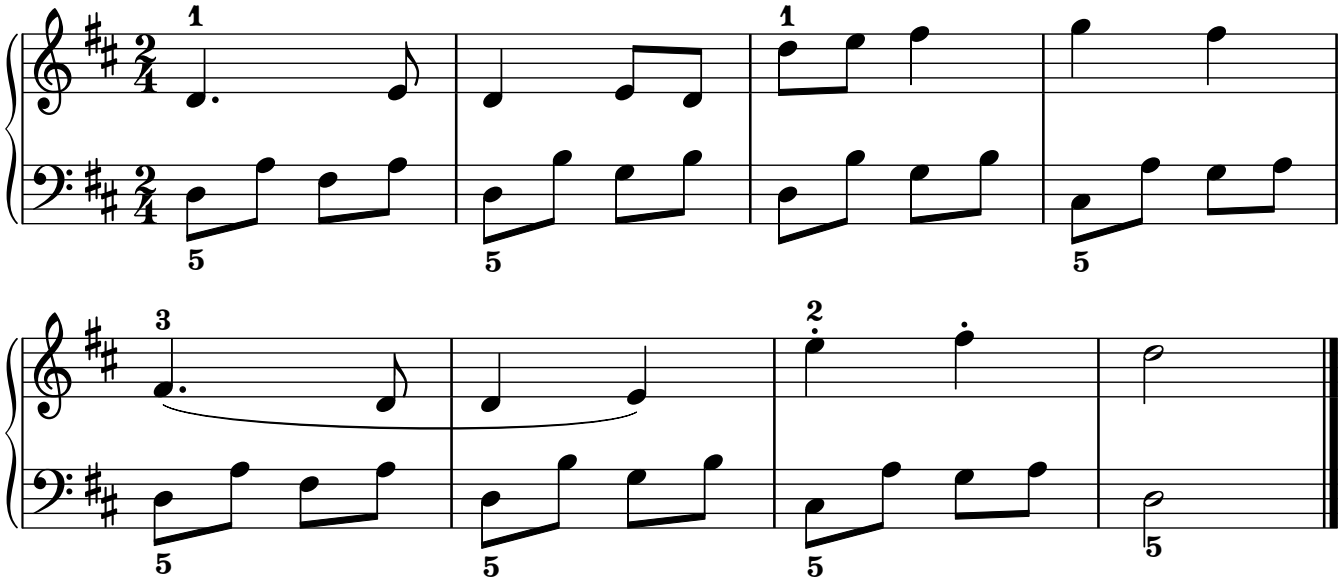
3.31
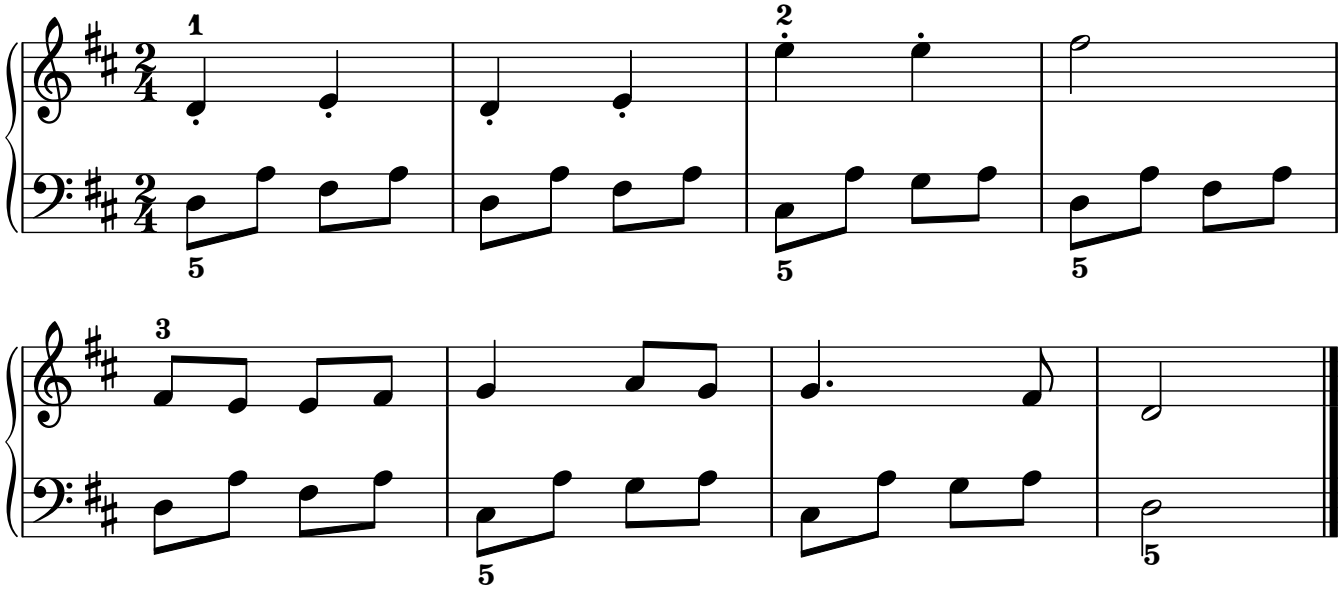


3.32



3.33



3.34
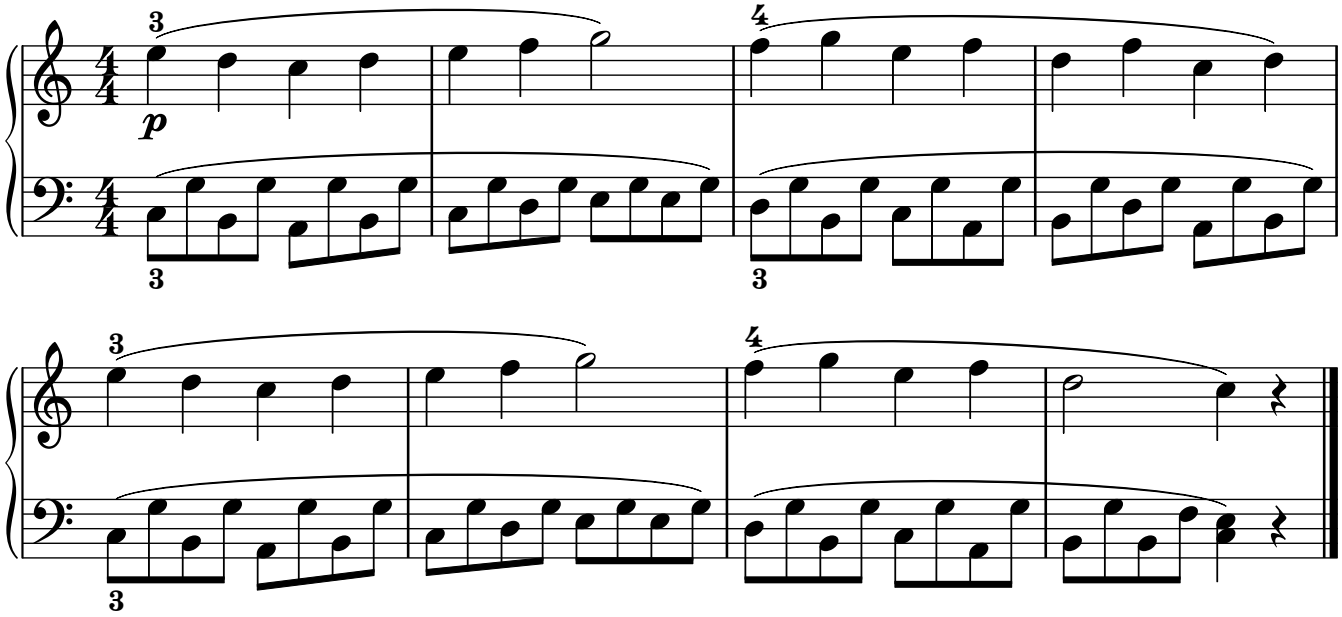


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Humming Song ♩ = 72

Robert Schumann, Op. 68 No. 3 (first section) - left hand an octave lower

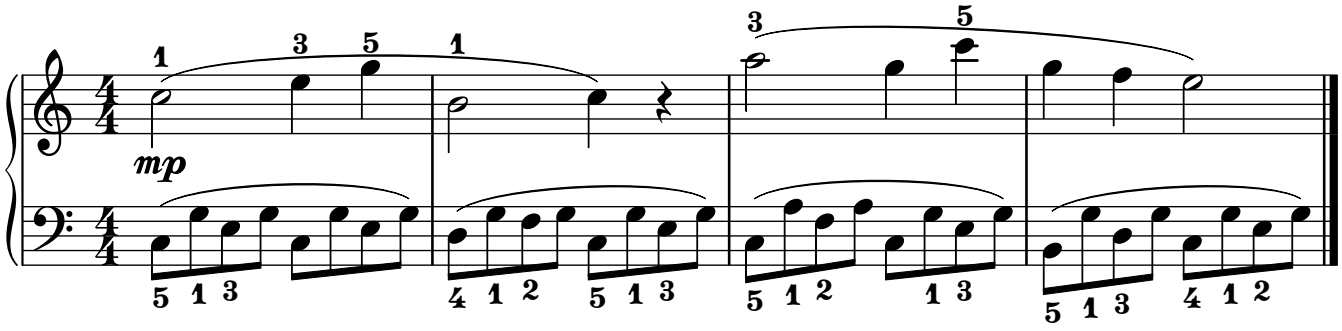
From Schumann's Album for the Young. The tune sits in high C position all the way through. Schumann wrote the left hand in the treble clef; here it is an octave lower, in the bass clef. Notes from Mutopia Project no. 651.



Sonata in C (opening) ♩ = 92

Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart, Sonata K. 545, first movement - simplified

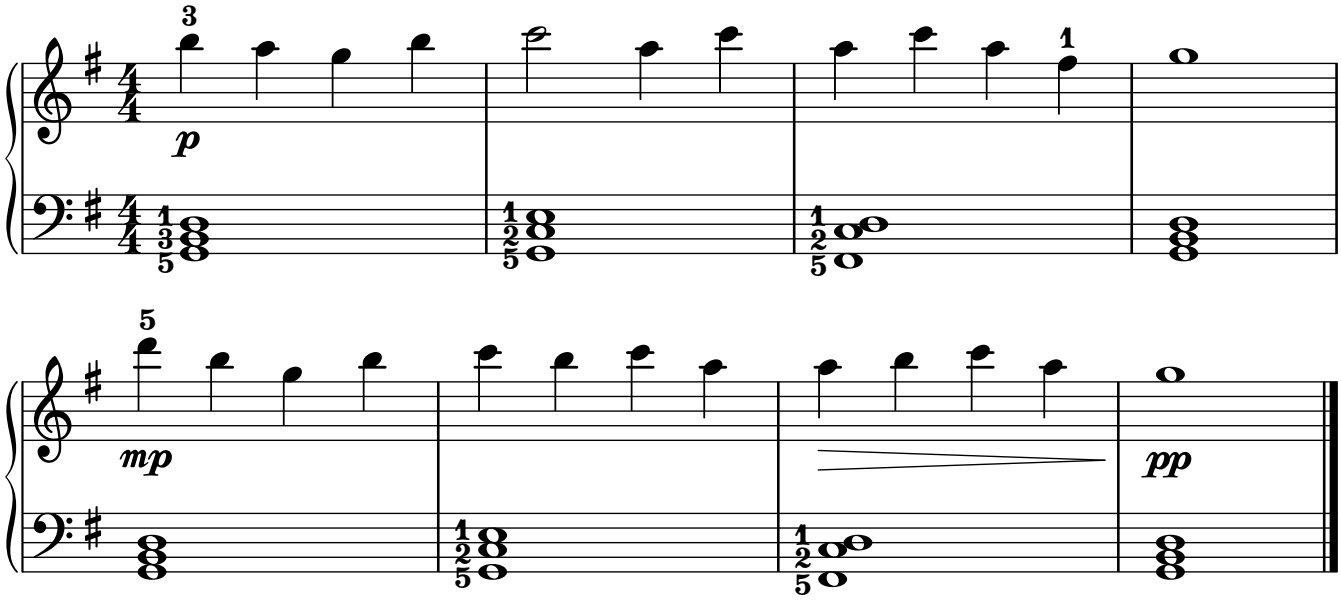
The famous opening of Mozart's 'easy' sonata. The tune climbs to high C in bar 3; the left hand plays an Alberti bass, here an octave lower than Mozart wrote it. The quick notes of bars 2 and 4 are simplified. Notes from Mutopia Project no. 998.



Starlight ♩ = 66

Original

A quiet piece in high G position: G5 above the staff up to D6. The left hand holds block chords. In bar 3 the thumb stretches down to F-sharp.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 4?

- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Name any note up to D6 at a glance, and make octave moves without looking down.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 4.